COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

SHAH JAHAN & THE EVOLUTION OF THE MUGHAL RULING CLASS
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STARTING QUESTION

How could the Mughal empire look so confident under Shah Jahan and yet leave behind
clear signs of pressure inside its ruling class and jagir structure?

1. REIGN FRAME

1628 enthronement
  -> visible imperial confidence
  -> larger, more composite service elite
  -> more claims on office / cavalry / jagirs
  -> month-scale and contingent adjustments
  -> 1657-58 succession war exposes transfer vulnerability

2. ACCESSION AND CONSOLIDATION

Jahangir dies (1627)
  -> Asaf Khan + leading nobles + army back Khurram
  -> rival princes / claimants removed
  -> Shah Jahan enthroned (1628)
  -> Bundela challenge + Khan Jahan Lodi challenge suppressed
  -> message: Mughal succession remains political-military, but becomes harsher

3. FRONTIER AND DECCAN AS BOUNDED EVIDENCE

Daulatabad / Ahmadnagar (1633)
  -> Deccan settlement (1636) = hierarchy / suzerainty, not total annexation
Balkh (1646-47)
  -> tactical reach
  -> logistical unsustainability
Qandahar (lost 1649; failed recoveries to 1653)
  -> siege and supply limits
Use in Topic 21:
  -> campaigns enlarge burden and claims
  -> full foreign-policy detail stays in Topic 19

4. MAGNIFICENCE AS POLITICAL LANGUAGE

Peacock Throne (1635 use)
  -> precedence / jewelled sovereignty
Taj Mahal
  -> dynastic memory / memorial kingship
Shahjahanabad (1638 onward)
  -> new capital / urban sovereignty / elite residence
Red Fort + Jama Masjid
  -> ceremonial centre / court-city axis
Moosvi cost caution
  -> significant spending, not automatic fiscal ruin

5. WHAT THE RULING CLASS WAS
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ranked imperial service elite
  -> mansab
  -> office
  -> jagir assignment
  -> military command
  -> court access / household proximity
  -> kinship and reputation
Trap:
  -> not a racial caste
  -> not a hereditary peerage in a simple European sense

6. COMPOSITIONAL CHANGE (500 ZAT AND ABOVE)

1595 total 123
1621 total 242
1647-48 total 443
1656 total 518
Key readings:
  -> Iranis and Turanis remain major, but combined proportional share falls
  -> Rajputs remain major military-political partners
  -> Afghans recover some space
  -> Indian Muslims remain important (Sadullah Khan as key name)
  -> small but real Maratha / Deccani inclusion
Conclusion:
  -> wider incorporation + denser competition for reward

7. MANSAB VOCABULARY
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zat   = personal rank / pay grade
sawar = cavalry obligation and related pay claim
jagir = transferable revenue assignment
jama = assessed revenue on paper
hasil = realised collection
khalisa = crown-retained revenue

dagh   = branding of horses
chehra = descriptive muster roll
Limit:
  -> verification matters, but borrowed men / horses show evasion remained possible

8. DU-ASPA SIH-ASPA + EFFECTIVE CONTINGENTS
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du-aspa sih-aspa
  -> first placed under Jahangir in the assigned source
  -> intensifies specified cavalry duty
  -> does NOT itself raise zat

one-third / one-fourth / one-fifth rules
  -> same-province jagir -> about one-third
  -> outside-province jagir -> about one-fourth
  -> harsh theatres (Balkh-Badakhshan, perhaps Deccan) -> one-fifth

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Worked example:
  2000 zat / 2000 sawar
  with 1000 du-aspa sih-aspa
  outside-province jagir
  -> 250 ordinary + 500 doubled = 750 effective contingent

9. MONTH-SCALE
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Why needed?
  -> paper assessment and real support diverge
Jagir scale:
  12-month -> 10-month -> 8-month -> 6-month -> 4-month
  Deccan could fall to 3-4 months because jama was especially inflated
Illustrative sawar rates:
  12-month -> Rs 40
  8-month  -> Rs 30
  6-month  -> Rs 25
Trap:
  -> month-scale is not a bonus
  -> it is a downward adjustment to effective yield

10. REVENUE GROWTH VERSUS ELITE GROWTH
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jama index:
  1595-96 = 100
  1627    = about 122
  1647-48 = about 162
  1656-57 = 176
higher elite:
  123 -> 518
Mechanism:
  more ranks / more claims + uneven hasil + limited productive jagirs + costly theatres
  -> be-jagiri roots + pressure on assignees, troopers and collectors
Verdict:
  -> system still functions
  -> later full jagirdari crisis belongs elsewhere

11. SUCCESSION WAR, 1657-58
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Shah Jahan ill (September 1657)
  -> Dara favoured but not constitutionally secured
  -> Shuja, Murad, Aurangzeb mobilise separate bases
  -> Dharmat + Samugarh = decisive battle sequence
  -> Shah Jahan confined in Agra
Meaning:
  -> princely households + noble networks become succession armies
  -> no fixed primogeniture
  -> not a simple liberal-vs-orthodox referendum
Boundary:
  -> Topic 21 stops at accession outcome
  -> Topic 22 begins after that outcome

12. EXAM TRAPS
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- jagir is not landownership
- jama is not hasil
- month-scale is not a reward
- du-aspa is not higher zat
- composite elite is not a harmonious federation
- frontier campaigning is not the same as durable control
- classical age is not identical to effortless empire

13. ANSWER SPINE

Opening line:
  Shah Jahan's reign displayed the Mughal empire at its most visibly ordered,
  but the same reign had to manage widening pressure inside the ruling class
  and jagir system.
Body order:
  accession and coercive consolidation
  -> bounded frontier and Deccan evidence
  -> magnificence as political language
  -> ruling-class composition
  -> mansab vocabulary and contingent rules
  -> month-scale and revenue pressure
  -> 1657-58 succession war
Qualified conclusion:
  visible apex + composite expansion + adaptive fiscal strain